

Skills – Descriptions/when they’re useful:

Strength – Athletic ability; raw strength such as how hard you can hit or push something

Athletics – Your ability to climb, jump, swim or otherwise perform strenuous activities.

Dexterity – A measure of your nimbleness; The ability to be quietly, careful or graceful.

Acrobatics – Your ability to make a graceful landing, stay on your feet, or land a difficult stunt

Sleight of Hand – The ability to use your hands in an agile way; for pickpocketing, slipping things in pockets, forging documents, as well as picking locks

Stealth – Remaining unseen or quiet. Finding an effective space to hide or covering your tracks.

Intelligence – Your book smarts; The ability to remember events, understand the arcane, and think on the fly.

Arcana – The ability to understand arcane sigils, recall magical lore, and understand spells and extraplanar beings.

History – Recollection of historical events, people, kingdoms, wars, and lost civilizations.

Investigation – Finding and connecting clues to deduce the location of hidden objects or people.

Nature – Understanding of nature, weather, plants, animals and how to survive certain terrains.

Religion – Recollection of deities, religions, cults, and recognition of holy or cultish symbolism.

Wisdom – Your ability to understand people and animals. A representation of your intuition.

Animal Handling – Understanding, calming, and taming of many different beasts.

Insight – How well you understand people. Reading into words and expressions to deduce their thoughts.

Medicine – Anatomical background, helping you dress wounds, find causes of ailments, or field dress a kill.

Perception – Measure of your awareness. How well you can here footsteps or spot someone watching you from behind a tree

Survival – How well you can identify, perceive, or predict changes in weather, dangerous animals nearby or other hazards while out in nature.

Charisma – Measure of your social skill. Your ability to convey your message to convince others.

Deception – Your ability to lie, whether that be verbally, through an accent, or with a disguise.

Intimidation – How well you can threaten others with your presence.

Performance – Getting an audience on your side, through speech, song, dance, or other means.

Persuasion – Convincing others that what you’re saying is a good idea.

Killing NPCs: Dungeons and Dragons is an RPG with a well fleshed out combat system, but it is also a game about storytelling. Killing monsters, creatures, and sometimes an evil necromancer is an important event and necessary. Keep in mind however that this is still a world with consequences, and not all problems can be solved with blind violence. Killing civilians, or sort of bad guys just because you don’t like them is a good way to end up imprisoned, or even killed yourself if you mess with powerful enough people. Keep in mind you’re the **HERO** of the story, and while that does involve a lot of fighting and killing, your actions have an impact on the world around you, good and bad.

MAKING RANGED ATTACKS

Spells and weapons have 2 range labels, normal/long. Past the normal range attacks have disadvantage, and after the long range the attack cannot hit. Range attacks have disadvantage if they are within 5 ft of a hostile creature who can see you and who isn’t incapacitated.

EXHAUSTION (CUMULATIVE)

1	Disadvantage on ability checks.	2	Speed halved.
3	Disadvantage on attack rolls and saving throws.	4	Hit Point maximum halved.
5	Speed reduced to 0.	6	Death.

Blinded	You cannot see. Automatically fail anything that requires sight. Attack rolls against you have advantage, and you have disadvantage to attack.
Charmed	You cannot attack the charmer. The charmer has advantage on any ability check to interact socially with you.
Deafened	You cannot hear and fail anything that requires hearing automatically.
Frightened	You have disadvantage on ability checks and attack rolls if you can see the source of your fear. You may not willingly move towards the source of your fear.
Grappled	You have a speed of 0. Ends if you can free yourself or if the grappler becomes incapacitated.
Incapacitated	You cannot take actions or reactions.
Invisible	You cannot be seen without magical aid or special sense. You may be detected by noise you make. Attack rolls against you have disadvantage. Your attack rolls have advantage.
Paralyzed	You are incapacitated and cannot move or speak. You automatically fail strength and dexterity saving throws. Attack rolls against you have advantage. Melee attacks against you automatically crit if they hit.
Petrified	Your weight increases 10x and you no longer age. You are incapacitated, and unaware of your surroundings. You’re resistant to all damage, and immune to poison and disease.
Poisoned	You have disadvantage on all attack rolls and ability checks.
Prone	You are on the floor. You can only crawl. You have disadvantage on attack rolls. Melee attacks have advantage on you. Effect ends when you stand.
Restrained	You have a speed of 0. You have disadvantage on attacks and dexterity saving throws. Attacks against you have advantage.
Stunned	You’re incapacitated. Attack rolls against you have advantage. You automatically fail strength and dexterity saving throws.
Unconscious	You are incapacitated, cannot move or speak, and are unaware of your surroundings. You automatically fail strength and dexterity checks. All attacks against you within 5ft are critical hits.

COMBAT

1 round of combat only lasts 6 seconds. Every player gets 1 action, 1 bonus action, 1 free action, movement, and 1 reaction every single round of combat. These can be used in any order.

Action	A player’s main activity during their turn. Choose one: attack, help, grapple, shove, dash, disengage, dodge, hide, ready, search, use an object, use shield, use class feature, or improvise.
Movement	A player may move at any time during their turn. Movement is limited by a player’s movement speed and may contain: climbing, swimming, crawling, jumping, dropping prone, standing up and/or regular movement like walking/running.
Bonus Action	A short action that states it is a bonus action. Ex: offhand attack, cast a spell with cast time of one bonus action, use class feature.
Free Action	Something inconsequential and short. Ex: pulling a dagger off your belt, talking.
Reaction	An action a player uses in response. Ex: opportunity attacks, readied action, cast a spell with cast time of 1 reaction.

Attack	Use any attack or cast a spell listed on your character sheet.
Help	Give an ally advantage on the next ability check you are helping with, or advantage to attack an enemy you are within 5 ft of until your next turn.
Grapple	Make a contested strength check to grapple the target.
Shove	Make a contested strength check to knock a target prone or push it 5 feet away.
Dash	Use your action to double your movement speed for the turn.
Disengage	Make a clean escape from the targets around you without provoking an opportunity attack.
Dodge	Until your next turn, attacks made against you have disadvantage and you have advantage on dexterity saving throws.
Hide	Make a stealth check to attempt to hide from enemies.
Ready	Ready an action to be used as your reaction at the condition specified. The player must announce what the action is and what triggers that action. Ex: a fighter holds his attack action until the enemy is within 5 feet of him.
Search	Use an investigation or perception check to search your surroundings.
Use an Object	An object that requires time to interact with. Ex: a key to open a door, activating a magical item.
Use Shield	Equip or unequip a shield.
Use Feature	Some features use actions.
Improvise	You are not bound to just these actions and your combat skills while in combat. Be creative but obey what your DM allows or doesn’t allow.



ADVANTAGE Roll 2 d20’s and take the highest, then add the respective modifier.

DISADVANTAGE Roll 2 d20’s and take the lowest, then add the respective modifier.

AC = ARMOR CLASS How hard it is to hit a target. A player must meet or beat the target’s AC to attack & deal damage to the target.

DC = DIFFICULTY CLASS A player must meet or beat the DC to succeed the task.

CRITICAL SUCCESS “Natural 20” When you roll a 20 on a d20, before modifiers. A critical success on an attack cannot miss, and does double the dice damage. A critical success doesn’t automatically pass skill checks, saves, etc.

CRITICAL FAILURE “Natural 1” When you roll a 1 on a d20, before modifiers. A critical failure on an attack always misses, regardless of modifiers. A critical failure doesn’t automatically fail skill checks, saves, etc.

RESTS

LONG REST	Must be 8 or more hours of rest. Regain all lost HP, all used spell slots, and half of your maximum hit dice rounded up, as well as any class/race features only usable once per long rest. Prepare spells if applicable.
SHORT REST	Must be 1 or more hours. You may choose to expend any number of hit dice to recover HP. The player rolls the die and adds the character’s Constitution modifier to it. Any abilities usable once per short rest will be regained.

SPELL CASTING

VERBAL (V)	Caster gagged or in area of silence cannot cast a spell with verbal component.
SOMATIC (S)	Caster must have one free hand to perform gestures for somatic component.
MATERIAL (M)	Caster can use component pouch or spellcasting focus. Must have specific component to cast spell, even if consumed by spell. Must have one hand free to access component.

CONCENTRATION

If concentration is lost, the spell ends. The caster can choose to end concentration at any time, no action required. Moving & attacking don’t interfere with concentration. A caster can only have one concentration spell active at a time. If a caster takes damage and fails their concentration check (DC = 10 or 1/2 damage amount, whichever is higher), is incapacitated, or killed, the spell ends.

GOING UNCONSCIOUS & DEATH SAVES

Once a player is at 0 HP, they are unconscious. On the unconscious player’s turn, they roll one d20 without adding any modifiers. 10 or higher is a success. 9 or less if a failure. On a critical success, the player becomes conscious with 1 HP. On a critical failure, it counts as 2 failures. The player rolls a death save every turn until they either have 3 successes (they stabilize and remain unconscious), 3 failures (they die), or is healed.